CASE STUDY

Search Boosts Bookings

Search campaign drives hotel management and development company's bookings, sales, and ROAS

adtaxi

A hotel management and development company had to adapt quickly to the ever-evolving travel space due to the global pandemic. They needed to capture more direct bookings and rely less on room bookings from third-party booking websites.

With that goal in mind, Adtaxi was challenged with crafting a strategy to capture the bottom-of-funnel search traffic where people are actively looking to book a hotel. Our initial focus leading up to peak booking season was to narrow in on the search network and run campaigns based on keyword areas like Branded, Geo Hotel Specific, and Conquest.

Campaigns were condensed, combining similar keywords and ad groups into two to four campaigns depending on geo-targeting, location-related keywords, and relevance. To maximize budgets, most strategies for a property are made up of one branded campaign and one general campaign. When appropriate, geo, conquest, and competitor campaigns are utilized as well.

Following the increasing brand budget, Adtaxi decided to pause the conquest campaign performance in order to reallocate the budget towards the general campaign. As we assessed conquest campaign performances, budgets shifted accordingly.

Utilizing call tracking allowed Adtaxi to successfully measure the effectiveness of the campaign to help us optimize future marketing strategies. With an impactful campaign, this strategy led to increased sales, occupancy, and ROAS.



CHALLENGES

Due to the pandemic and economic climate, fewer travelers booking stays

Not meeting objectives by relying on third-party booking websites

Current funnel not reaching consumers actively looking to book hotels



SOLUTIONS

Utilized occupancy data to influence optimizations and budget allocations

Call tracking for phone bookings and transactions driven by Google Ads

A refined targeting strategy to reach bottom-of-the-funnel search traffic



RESULTS

12x
increase in ROAS

30%
increased revenue tracked from call-in bookings

Implemented full-funnel tracking

Increasing Bookings

The hotel management and development company's main objective was to increase sales and occupancy rates for all properties, increase direct-to-site ecommerce sales, and improve overall ROAS.

Sales could come from transactions on the website that Adtaxi tracked or bookings made over the phone that we could attribute through CallRail, our call tracking software.

A New Strategy

Adtaxi used search ads specifically to drive online sales. Our search campaigns were solely focused on driving revenue, with hotel rooms as the inventory -- so those two key factors informed our ongoing strategy and campaign goals.

Challenging Conditions

A central challenge to the success of the campaign was environmental - after all, during the beginning of the global pandemic and economic crisis, fewer consumers were traveling and actively looking to book hotels. To overcome this challenge the Adtaxi team employed a highly refined targeting strategy, making extensive use of Google's audience creation automation and our own proprietary automation technology to identify and successfully capture bottom-of-the-funnel search traffic.

Key Insights

A deep-dive audit on their existing Google Ad accounts was necessary to identify holes in their existing strategy and rework the account structures to fit Adtaxi's best practices. Making extensive use of Google's audience creation automation and our own proprietary automation technology aided us in identifying and successfully capturing bottom-of-funnel search traffic. Additionally, the client's occupancy data was vital in helping Adtaxi directly influence optimizations and budget allocations.

Critical Analysis

Adtaxi also inherited a less-than-perfect marketing strategy - so the first challenge was to right the ship.

We conducted deep-dive audits on their existing Google Ad accounts and identified many holes in their existing strategy. We took over all existing accounts and reworked the account structures to fit our best practices while utilizing proven strategies with successful performance records.

Additionally, the client sharing occupancy data with us directly influenced our optimizations and budget allocations.

Expertise & Innovation

Adtaxi ran a highly successful search campaign, leveraging our expertise as a Google Partner in tandem with our own automation technology, including our proprietary search pacing tool, in-house scripts, and automated email alerts.

The client's former agency was running SEM at around a 6x ROAS. Over the same six months, Adtaxi's SEM averaged a 10.2x ROAS. Compared to their pre-COVID data, our efforts delivered a significant improvement: SEM on its own averaged a 10.2x ROAS over 6 months.

Offline Attribution

In addition, Adtaxi implemented call tracking, which allowed us to track additional, over-the-phone bookings and transactions driven by our Google Ads campaigns.

The revenues from these transactions added an additional 30% not reflected in the above ROAS numbers, bringing the six-month average to around 12x.